Damn Fast DFIR — Linux Cheat Sheet

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Live Linux triage commands per artifact, with the bash primary and probe-and-degrade fallbacks.

OFFLINE FIELD REFERENCE
A4 print edition
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src: dfd_live_linux_baseline_cheatsheet.html

1 · SYSTEM INFORMATION — OS, kernel, boot time, CPU, RAM

BASH

```
uname -sr
uname -m
cat /etc/os-release
awk '/^btime/{print $2}' /proc/stat
awk '{print int($1)}' /proc/uptime
awk '/^MemTotal/{print $2}' /proc/meminfo
nproc
date
```

2 · LOCAL USERS — All local accounts from /etc/passwd

BASH

```
awk -F: 'BEGIN{OFS="\t"} {print $1,$3,$4,$6,$7,$5}' /etc/passwd
```

3 · PRIVILEGED ACCOUNTS — UID 0 accounts (root-equivalent)

BASH

```
awk -F: '$3==0 {print $1, $7}' /etc/passwd
```

3 · PRIVILEGED ACCOUNTS — Admin group membership (sudo, wheel, admin, root, adm)

BASH

```
getent group sudo wheel admin root adm
```

3 · PRIVILEGED ACCOUNTS — Sudoers files

BASH

```
ls -la /etc/sudoers /etc/sudoers.d/
```

4 · LOGGED-ON USERS — Currently active sessions

BASH (MODERN)

```
w
```

BASH (FALLBACK)

```
who
```

5 · LOGIN HISTORY — Recent logins from wtmp

BASH (MODERN)

```
last -F -w
```

BASH (FALLBACK)

```
last
utmpdump /var/log/wtmp
```

6 · NETWORK INTERFACES — Interface state, MAC addresses, IP addresses

BASH (MODERN)

```
ip -o link show
ip -o addr show
```

BASH (FALLBACK)

```
ifconfig -a
```

7 · ACTIVE CONNECTIONS — Established / active TCP and UDP sockets with owning process

BASH (MODERN)

```
ss -tunap
```

BASH (FALLBACK)

```
netstat -tunap
```

8 · LISTENING PORTS — TCP and UDP listeners with owning process

BASH (MODERN)

```
ss -tlnp
ss -ulnp
```

BASH (FALLBACK)

```
netstat -tulnp
```

9 · ROUTING TABLE — Active routes

BASH (MODERN)

```
ip route show
```

BASH (FALLBACK)

```
route -n
```

10 · ARP / NEIGHBORS — Recently communicated hosts on the local network

BASH (MODERN)

```
ip neigh show
```

BASH (FALLBACK)

```
arp -an
```

11 · DNS & HOSTS — Resolver configuration

BASH

```
grep -E '^[[:space:]]*(nameserver|search|domain)' /etc/resolv.conf
```

11 · DNS & HOSTS — Static host overrides

BASH

```
grep -vE '^[[:space:]]*(#|$)' /etc/hosts
```

12 · RUNNING PROCESSES — PID, PPID, owner, executable path, SHA256, command line

BASH

```
ls /proc/[0-9]*/
awk '/^PPid:/{print $2}' /proc/<pid>/status
awk '/^Name:/{print $2}' /proc/<pid>/status
tr '\0' ' ' < /proc/<pid>/cmdline
readlink /proc/<pid>/exe
stat -c '%U %Y' /proc/<pid>
sha256sum <exe>
```

13 · SERVICES — Service units and their load / active / sub state

BASH (MODERN)

```
systemctl list-units --type=service --all --plain --no-legend --no-
   pager
```

BASH (FALLBACK)

```
ls /etc/init.d/
```

14 · CRON JOBS — System and user cron entries

BASH

```
grep -vE '^[[:space:]]*(#|$)' /etc/crontab
grep -vE '^[[:space:]]*(#|$)' /etc/cron.d/*
grep -vE '^[[:space:]]*(#|$)' /var/spool/cron/crontabs/*
grep -vE '^[[:space:]]*(#|$)' /var/spool/cron/*
ls /etc/cron.hourly/ /etc/cron.daily/ /etc/cron.weekly/
   /etc/cron.monthly/
```

15 · SYSTEMD TIMERS — Timer units (systemd equivalent of cron)

BASH

```
systemctl list-timers --all --no-legend --no-pager
```

16 · AUTOSTART / PERSISTENCE Init scripts

BASH

```
ls -la /etc/rc.local /etc/rc.d/rc.local
```

16 · AUTOSTART / PERSISTENCE Global shell init files

BASH

```
ls -la /etc/profile.d/
stat /etc/profile /etc/bash.bashrc
```

16 · AUTOSTART / PERSISTENCE Per-user shell init files (UID ≥ 1000 and root)

BASH

```
stat ~/.bashrc ~/.bash_profile ~/.profile ~/.bash_login ~/.zshrc
```

17 · KERNEL MODULES Loaded kernel modules

BASH (MODERN)

```
lsmod
```

BASH (FALLBACK)

```
cat /proc/modules
```

18 · SUID / SGID FILES Files with elevated permission bits (setuid / setgid)

BASH

```
find / -xdev -type f -perm /6000
```

19 · INSTALLED PACKAGES Package inventory (uses first available package manager)

BASH (DEBIAN / UBUNTU)

```
dpkg-query -W -f='${Package}\t${Version}\t${Architecture}\n'
```

BASH (RHEL / CENTOS)

```
rpm -qa --qf '%{NAME}\t%{VERSION}-%{RELEASE}\t%{ARCH}\n'
```

BASH (ARCH)

```
pacman -Q
```

BASH (ALPINE)

```
apk info -v
```

20 · FIREWALL RULES Active firewall configuration

BASH

```
nft list ruleset
iptables -S
iptables -t nat -S
ufw status verbose
```

21 · MOUNTED FILESYSTEMS Mounted devices and options

BASH (MODERN)

```
cat /proc/mounts
```

BASH (FALLBACK)

```
mount
```

22 · SSH AUTHORIZED KEYS Keys permitted to log in via SSH

BASH

```
cat /root/.ssh/authorized_keys
cat /home/*/.ssh/authorized_keys
```

23 · FAILED LOGINS Failed SSH authentication attempts from auth logs

BASH (MODERN)

```
journalctl --no-pager --since "-7 days" -t sshd -t sshd-session | \
    grep -iE 'failed password|authentication failure|invalid user'
```

BASH (FALLBACK)

```
grep -hiE 'failed password|authentication failure|invalid user' \
    /var/log/auth.log /var/log/secure
```

24 · SUCCESSFUL LOGINS Successful remote authentications from auth logs

BASH (MODERN)

```
journalctl --no-pager --since "-7 days" -t sshd -t sshd-session | \
    grep -iE 'accepted (password|publickey|keyboard)'
```

BASH (FALLBACK)

```
grep -hiE 'accepted (password|publickey|keyboard)' \
    /var/log/auth.log /var/log/secure
```